

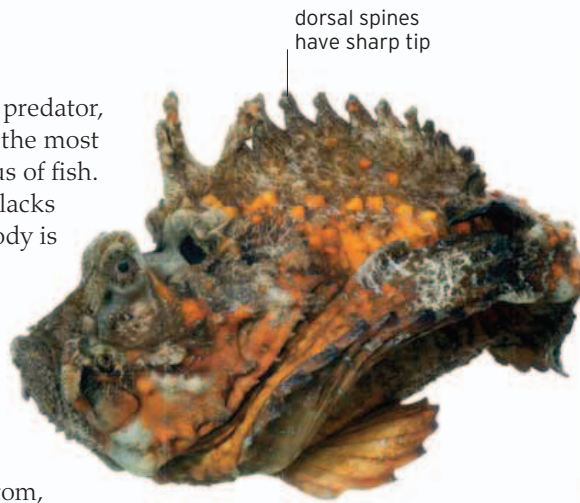
Stonefish

Synanceia verrucosa

- ↔ Up to 16 in (40 cm)
- 📍 Indo-Pacific, E. Africa
- ⊗ Not known

A stout, slow-moving predator, this species is among the most dangerously venomous of fish. The aptly named fish lacks scales—instead, its body is covered in glandular warts, which afford perfect camouflage against the rocky background of its coral reef habitat. It usually stays motionless at the bottom,

waiting to ambush passing prey, sometimes half burying itself in the seabed.



Giant grouper

Epinephelus lanceolatus

- ↔ Up to 9 ft (2.7 m)
- 📍 Indian Ocean, W. and C. Pacific
- ⊗ Vulnerable

One of the largest bony fish on coral reefs, the giant grouper is a widespread predator, ranging throughout the warm coastal waters of the Indo-Pacific region. Young fish have a black, white, and yellow beelike pattern, but adults are uniformly gray with some mottling. Like most other grouper species, this fish may be a sequential hermaphrodite, in which the gonads can change to produce either eggs or sperm.

Emperor angelfish

Pomacanthus imperator

- ↔ Up to 16 in (40 cm)
- 📍 Indian Ocean, Pacific
- ⊗ Common

Large members of the butterflyfish family, marine angelfish are characterized by a side-flattened body, bright colors, small mouth, and comblike teeth. Juveniles have striking blue-and-white ringlike markings. However, after two years, they change to their adult form, with a yellow tail, longitudinal blue and yellow stripes, and a black face mask. Emperor angelfish graze on sponges and algae in their coral-reef habitat.

Atlantic bluefin tuna

Thunnus thynnus

- ↔ Up to 15 ft (4.6 m)
- 📍 Atlantic
- ⊗ Endangered

The torpedo-shaped Atlantic bluefin tuna is one of the fastest fish, reaching speeds of at least 40 mph (70 km/h) in pursuit of mackerel and squid. Its tail helps propulsion, while its circulatory system helps it to retain body heat. Oxygen is extracted from water across thin-walled blood vessels, and high hemoglobin levels allow it to deliver oxygen to its muscles highly effectively.



Atlantic mudskipper

Periophthalmus barbarus

- ↔ Up to 10 in (25 cm)
- 📍 E. Atlantic
- ⊗ Locally common

Mudskippers are amphibious members of the goby family. They can use their pectoral fins to “walk” out of water and can extract oxygen from air through their throat lining and skin. An enlarged gill cavity also works much like a lung. Like other mudskipper species, the Atlantic mudskipper uses these adaptations to stay active and to feed on mudflats at low tide.

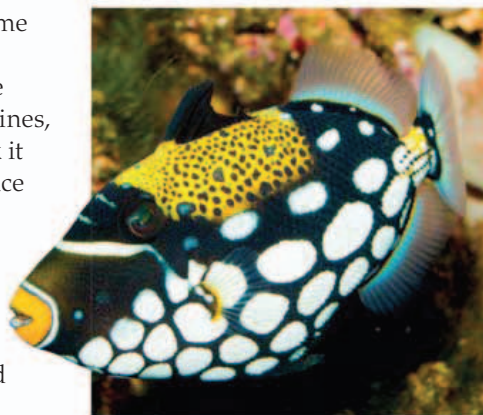
Clown triggerfish

Balistoides conspicillum

- ↔ Up to 20 in (50 cm)
- 📍 Pacific, Indian Ocean
- ⊗ Not known

This coral-reef fish gets its name from its colorful body, with yellow lips, and the triggerlike mechanism of its dorsal fin spines, which, when erected, can lock it into the safety of a rocky crevice as protection from predators. Its large head is covered with tough, protective scales and measures a third of its total length. Although its mouth is small, it has strong jaws and incisorlike teeth for crushing

hard-shelled invertebrate prey, including crustaceans, mollusks, and echinoderms. Like other triggerfish, this species can be very territorial, especially during the mating season.



Atlantic halibut

Hippoglossus hippoglossus

- ↔ Up to 8 ft (2.4 m)
- 📍 North Atlantic, Arctic
- ⊗ Endangered

This commercially valuable—but overfished—species is one of the largest of the flatfish. Juvenile flatfish are upright-swimming and have unmodified symmetrical anatomy. But as they develop, one eye migrates to the other side of the head. The adult fish settles on its “blind” side and becomes bottom-living. The Atlantic halibut has both eyes on its right side—other flatfish species may have eyes on their left or right side.

Other species

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Salvelinus alpinus » p33
- Atlantic salmon
Salmo salar » p137
- Barrier Reef anemonefish
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- Electric eel
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- Great barracuda
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